

Geometric and Negative Binomial distributions

Geometric distribution $X \sim \text{Geom}(p)$

It is used to model the number of independent trials until the first “success” happens.

Definition

We say $X \sim \text{Geom}(p)$, then

X : = number of trials until first success happens (we also count the trial in which success happens)

X can take values, $1, 2, 3, 4, \dots$

$$P(X = k) = p(1 - p)^{k-1}; \text{ where } k = 1, 2, 3, \dots$$

$$E[X] = \frac{1}{p}$$

$$\text{Var}(X) = \frac{1 - p}{p^2}$$

Eg 3. A slot machine at a casino randomly rewards 15% of the attempts. Assume that all attempts are independent.

(a) What is the probability that your first reward occurs on your fourth trial?

X = number of trials until first reward

$$p(\text{reward}) = 0.15 \quad \Rightarrow \quad X \sim \text{Geom}(0.15)$$

$$\begin{aligned} p(X=4) &= (0.15) (0.85)^{4-1} \\ &= (0.15) (0.85)^3 \end{aligned}$$

Eg 3. A slot machine at a casino randomly rewards 15% of the attempts. Assume that all attempts are independent.

(b) What is the probability that your first reward occurs on your seventh trial?

X = number of trials until first reward

$$p(\text{reward}) = 0.15 \quad \Rightarrow \quad X \sim \text{Geom}(0.15)$$

$$\begin{aligned} p(X = 7) &= (0.15) (0.85)^{7-1} \\ &= (0.15) (0.85)^6 \end{aligned}$$

Eg 3. A slot machine at a casino randomly rewards 15% of the attempts. Assume that all attempts are independent.

(c) What is the probability that you get three rewards in ten trials?

Y = number of rewards (success) in ten trials

$$Y \sim \text{Bin}(n=10, p=0.15)$$

$$\begin{aligned} P(Y=3) &= \binom{10}{3} p^3 (1-p)^7 \\ &= \binom{10}{3} (0.15)^3 (0.85)^7 \end{aligned}$$

Eg 3. A slot machine at a casino randomly rewards 15% of the attempts. Assume that all attempts are independent.

(d) What is the probability that your third reward occurs on your tenth trial?

$p = \text{probability of success in one trial} = 0.15.$

$r = 3$

$X := \text{number of independent trials until 3 successes occur}$

$X \sim \text{NBin}(r=3, p=0.15)$

$$p(X=10) = \binom{9}{2} p^3 (1-p)^7 = \binom{9}{2} (0.15)^3 (0.85)^7$$

Negative Binomial distribution $X \sim NBin(r, p)$

It is used to model the number of independent trials until r “success” happens.

Definition

We say $X \sim NBin(r, p)$, then

X : = number of trials until r success occurs

X can take values, $r, r + 1, r + 2, \dots, \infty$

$$P(X = k) = \binom{k-1}{r-1} p^r (1-p)^{k-r}$$

$$E[X] = \frac{r}{p}$$

$$Var(X) = \frac{r(1-p)}{p^2}$$

Eg 3. A slot machine at a casino randomly rewards 15% of the attempts. Assume that all attempts are independent.

(e) What is the probability that the forth reward occurs on the fifteen trials?

$p = \text{probability of success in one trial} = 0.15.$

$r = 4$

$X := \text{number of independent trial untill 4 success occurs}$

$X \sim \text{NBin}(r=4, p=0.15)$

$$p(X=15) = \binom{14}{3} p^4 (1-p)^{11} = \binom{14}{3} (0.15)^4 (0.85)^{11}$$